

What is punctuation?

PUNCTUATION REFERS TO THE MARKS USED IN WRITING THAT HELP READERS UNDERSTAND WHAT THEY ARE READING.

Sometimes words alone are not enough to convey a writer's message clearly. They need a little help from punctuation marks to illustrate relationships between words, pauses, or even emotions.

Several of the main **punctuation marks** also have **uses** in **mathematical** notation.

Punctuation marks

There are twelve commonly used punctuation marks. Using punctuation marks correctly and carefully makes it possible for a writer to convey his or her message clearly. Punctuation can also enable the writer to control whether text is read quickly or slowly.

Period

This marks the end of a sentence.

EXAMPLE

The dog slept.



Ellipsis

This represents an unfinished sentence or omitted text.

EXAMPLE

Everything seemed calm, but then...



Comma

This joins or separates elements in a sentence.

EXAMPLE

Hearing a cat, he jumped up.

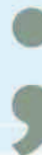


Semicolon

This joins two main clauses or separates items in a list.

EXAMPLE

He ran after the cat;
it ran up a tree.



Colon

This introduces text in a sentence.

EXAMPLE

He was interested in one thing: chasing the cat.



Apostrophe

This marks the possessive or omitted text.

EXAMPLE

The dog's owner couldn't see the cat.

